

Yağmur Kiper

she/her/hers

updated: Jul 2, 2026

Department of Linguistics, University of California Santa Cruz

Santa Cruz, CA 95064

ykipper@ucsc.edu | yagmurkipper.github.io

Research Interests

Primary	theoretical syntax; C/case, ellipsis, copular clauses, nominalizations, relative clauses
Secondary	theoretical semantics; evidentiality, modality, aspect, attitude reports

Education

2022–2027	Ph.D. in Linguistics University of California, Santa Cruz Committee: Mia Gong & Maziar Toosarvandani (co-chairs), Ivy Sichel Dissertation: The illusion of case (<i>tentative</i>)
2020–2022	Ph.D. Studies in Language Studies Middle East Technical University, Ankara
2017–2020	M.A. in English Language Teaching, Language Studies Middle East Technical University, Ankara Thesis: <i>In the case of sluicing</i> (<i>awarded best thesis '21</i>) Committee: Martina Gračanin-Yüksek (chair), Bilal Kırkıcı, İsa Kerem Bayırlı
2013–2017	B.A. in Foreign Language Education Middle East Technical University, Ankara

Appointments

2017–2019	Lecturer, Department of Foreign Languages TOBB University of Economics and Technology
-----------	---

Papers

Conference Proceedings

to appear	Kiper, Yağmur. Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case theory . In Gabriel Correa & Kevin Morand (eds.), <i>Proceedings of the Fifty-Sixth Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society: GLSA</i> .
-----------	---

* = co-first authors

2022 **Kiper, S Yağmur.** [The position of the Q-like particle *ki* in Turkish and consequences for sluicing](#). In Marianne Huijsmans & Sander Nederveen (eds.), *Proceedings of the Northwest Linguistics Conference 37*. Vancouver, BC: UBCWPL.

Manuscripts

in prep **Kiper, Yağmur.** What does disconnectivity tell us about ellipsis?

2020 **Kiper, S Yağmur.** [In the case of sluicing](#) [Master of Arts Thesis]. Middle East Technical University. OpenMETU.

Edited Volumes

2025 Nikolas Webster, **Yağmur Kiper**, Richard Wang, & Sichen Larry Lyu (eds). [Proceedings of the 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics \(WCCFL41\)](#). Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.

Presentations

Peer-reviewed

2026 **Kiper, Yağmur.** Distinct mechanisms for genitive case across nominalizations. *Talk at the 19th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics (WAFL 19)*. The Leibniz-Centre General Linguistics; Berlin, Germany.

2026 **Kiper, Yağmur*** & Knick, Emily*. Perfect-like meanings in Turkish via temporal adverbials. *Poster at 11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+11)*. MIT; Boston, MA.

2025 **Kiper, Yağmur.** Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case. *Talk at the 56th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society (NELS 56)*. NYU; New York.

2025 **Kiper, Yağmur.** Low sluicing is VPE. *Talk at the 101st Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA)*. Philadelphia.

2021 **Kiper, S Yağmur.** (Mis)matches in Turkish sluicing constructions. *Short Talk at Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)*. Université de Paris; online.

2021 **Kiper, S Yağmur.** Connectivity in Turkish sluicing. *Talk at the 23rd Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 23)*. Sogang University; online.

2021 **Kiper, S Yağmur.** The position of the Q-like particle *ki* in Turkish and consequences for sluicing. *Talk at the 37th Annual Northwest Linguistics Conference (NWLC 37)*. University of British Columbia; online.

2017 **Kiper, S Yağmur.** L1 Turkish transfer in the acquisition of L2 English definite article. *Talk at the 11th Student Conference on Linguistics (DÖK 11).* Mersin University; Mersin, Türkiye.

2016 **Kiper, S Yağmur.** L1 Turkish transfer in the acquisition of L2 English definite article. *Talk at the T.W.I.S.T. Conference in Linguistics (TWISTx10).* Leiden University; Leiden, Netherlands.

Invited

2026 **Kiper, Yağmur.** Two distinct mechanisms for genitive case assignment across nominalizations. *Talk at the Syntax & Semantics Circle (SSCircle),* University of California Berkeley.

2025 **Kiper, Yağmur.** The interaction between low sluicing and case licensing. *Talk at the Syntax and Morphology Circle (SMircle),* Stanford University.

Local

2025 **Kiper, Yağmur.** Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case theory. *Talk at the Syntax & Semantics Circle (SCircle),* 10 Oct, UC Santa Cruz.

2025 **Kiper, Yağmur.** Ellipsis meets case: an analysis of low sluicing and its interaction with case theory. *Talk at the Syntax & Semantics Circle (SCircle),* 2 May, UC Santa Cruz.

2025 **Kiper, Yağmur.** The semantics of imperfectives in Turkish. *Talk at the Spring Research Symposium (SRS),* 11 Apr, UC Santa Cruz.

2024 **Kiper, Yağmur.** Low sluicing in Turkish is VPE. *Talk at the Spring Research Symposium (SRS),* 19 Apr, UC Santa Cruz.

Experience

Teaching

2023–present

Teaching Assistant

Department of Linguistics, UC Santa Cruz

LING 80K: Invented Languages	Andrew Angeles	Spring 2026
LING 116: Semantics II	Adrian Brasoveanu	Winter 2026
LING 53: Syntax I	Roumyana Pancheva	Fall 2025
LING 113: Syntax II	Ivy Sichel	Spring 2025
LING 116: Semantics II	Jess Law	Winter 2025
LING 53: Semantics I	Pranav Anand	Fall 2024
LING 53: Semantics I	Yaqing Cao	Summer 2024
LING 50: Introduction to Linguistics	Andrew Angeles	Spring 2024

LING 80D: Language and Mind	Rachel Walker	Winter 2024
LING 112: Syntax I	Ivy Sichel	Fall 2023

2019–2022

Teaching Assistant

Department of Foreign Language Education, Middle East Technical University

FLE 433: Advanced Syntax	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Spring 2022
FLE 337: Aspects of Bi-/Multi-lingualism	Hale Işık Güler	Spring 2022
FLE 134: Contextual Grammar II	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Fall 2021
FLE 307: Language Acquisition	Çiğdem Sağın Şimşek	Fall 2021
FLE 333: Introduction to Syntax	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Fall 2021
FLE 337: Aspects of Bi-/Multi-lingualism	Bilal Kırkıcı	Spring 2021
FLE 261: Linguistics II	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Spring 2021
FLE 146: Linguistics I	Hale Işık Güler	Fall 2020
FLE 425: School Experience	Işıl Günseli Kaçar	Fall 2020
FLE 420: Practice Teaching	Çiler Hatipoğlu	Spring 2020
FLE 426: The English Lexicon	Duygu Özge	Spring 2020
FLE 251: Critical Reading & Writing	Işıl Günseli Kaçar	Fall 2019

2017-2019

Instructor of Record

Department of Foreign Languages, TOBB University of Economics and Technology

ING 003: Professional Writing Skills

ING 002: Academic English II

ING 001: Academic English I

Integrated Language Skills

English Grammar

Mentoring

2026	<i>Copular Clauses and Case in “Altaic”</i> funded by Science Internship Program Mentee(s): Allegra OGrady, Neo Zhang
2025	<i>Ellipsis Investigations in “Altaic”</i> funded by Science Internship Program Mentee(s): Tanay Agrawal, Jonathan Ding, Adithya Gnanasundar, Dani Mattson
2024–2025	SLUG Career Mentorship Program , Department of Linguistics at UC Santa Cruz Mentee(s): Ella Kohls
2024	<i>Applying to Grad School Workshop</i> , Department of Linguistics at UC Santa Cruz with Ian Carpick & Richard Wang

Non-degree Training

2026	Equitable Course Design for GSIs Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz
------	---

2026	Graduate Pedagogy Fellowship Program Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz
2024	Preparing for Inclusive Teaching Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz
2023	The 5th Crete Summer School of Linguistics (CreteLing) University of Crete, Greece
2023	Teaching as an Ethical Practice: A Guide for Teaching Assistants (online) Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz
2021	The NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (NYI) Virtual
2019	DGfS xPrag Summer School Leibniz-Centre General Linguistics (ZAS), Germany
2016	Erasmus Exchange in British and American Studies University of Konstanz, Germany

Awards, Grants & Fellowships

2026	<i>Graduate Dean's Research Travel Grant</i> , UC Santa Cruz (\$150)
2026	<i>First Generation Graduate Group Research and Travel Awards</i> , UC Santa Cruz (\$500)
2026	<i>Graduate Pedagogy Fellow</i> , UC Santa Cruz Teaching & Learning Center (\$2000)
2025	<i>Humanities Summer Research Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute (\$2500)
2022–2023	<i>Regents Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Department of Linguistics (\$24,000)
2022	<i>Graduate Student Success Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute (\$1500)
2021	<i>Best Graduate Thesis Award</i> , Middle East Technical University
2020	<i>Tuition Fellowship for Summer School</i> , The NYI Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (\$225, declined)
2017–2019	<i>National Scholarship Program for MA Students</i> , The Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TÜBİTAK) (\$9000)
2016	<i>Erasmus+ Grant for the Student Exchange Program</i> , Turkish National Agency and European Union (€2000)

Service

at University of California Santa Cruz

2025–2026	Graduate Student Representative, Department of Linguistics
2024–2025	Member, Equity in Linguistics (EquiL)
2023–2024	Coordinator, Syntax & Semantics Circle (S-Circle)
2023	Organizing Committee Member, The 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 41)
2022–2024	Member, Linguistics Events Committee

at Middle East Technical University

2021–2022	Coordinator, Technical and Technological Support Group
2021–2022	Co-organizer, Formal Linguistics Meetings
2020–2021	Co-organizer, 34th National Conference on Turkish Linguistics (UDK 34)
2016–2017	Co-organizer, Colloquium Talk Series in Linguistics & Literature
2016	Co-founder, Language Studies Society

Skills

Languages Turkish (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate), Korean (research), Khalkha Mongolian (ex-situ fieldwork)

Programming Software Python, R
L^AT_EX, IBM SPSS, OpenSesame, Praat